

Preference Ranking v5 Certification Tips

Please remember to grade each dimension individually

Truthfulness vs Instruction Following

- ❖ This is particularly important for **Q&A types of requests**, i.e. where the user is asking the model a question. In these cases, if the model attempts to answer the question, it is *Fully following instructions* (all the instructions, if there is nothing else specified in the request). If the answer however is just wrong, this should be penalized only in Truthfulness.
- ❖ As an example applicable to the certification: Pay closer attention to **history/art-related requests**, and make sure all information present in these responses is correct. If the main information/point of the response is incorrect, this should be marked as *Not Truthful*. If some more 'minor' details, supporting information, is not correct, then mark as *Partially Truthful*.
 - But do not be too nitpicky when grading Truthfulness - if something can maybe be interpreted as possibly incorrect, do not penalize it. Only penalize information that is definitely not correct. For example, in tasks related to music genres, do not penalize unnecessarily: Genres are a somewhat subjective matter, so as long as the response is sensible and mentioning realistically plausible genres for the lyrics, do not penalize IF or Truthfulness; Responses listing different genres can still all be good and *Highly Satisfying*.
 - And keep that in mind for these history/art-related tasks, that generally at least one response will have no issues with Truthfulness, while the other two likely contain some historical errors. For Instructions Following, since the model generally does attempt to answer the user's question as mentioned in the first point, the instructions are mostly followed in these history/art-related tasks.
- ❖ Please don't hurry to penalize Instruction Following in general, but carefully check if what you noticed is really a specific instruction that can be traced back to the user request, or if it's actually the model just introducing incorrect information in the response (Truthfulness). For example, if the user requests to have something be in alphabetical order, or not to use certain letters, and the model fails to do this, this should be penalized in Instruction Following, not Truthfulness.
- ❖ Also remember that for **math problems** specifically, if the final answer of the math problem is incorrect, this means the response is *Not Truthful*. And if the final answer is correct, but there is a mistake in the steps/reasoning, this should be *Partially Truthful*.

- ❖ For **unsafe requests**, like ones asking to build a weapon for example, please remember that declining these harmful requests should be marked as *Fully Following Instructions* as well as *Truthful*, as this is the desired approach for such cases (pages 29 and 177). But, if the model does provide an answer, this should also be marked as *Fully Following Instructions*, and as *Truthful* if the info is indeed true, as the main instruction (to provide an answer to the question), is fully followed, even though it's harmful. Afterwards, just make sure you penalize this harmfulness of the response in Satisfaction, and mark as *Highly Unsatisfying*, again as per the Guidelines (page 192)

Concision

- Concision is fine in most tasks, but be wary of responses which introduce clearly unnecessary information, making it difficult for the user to locate the info that they asked for. This would be for example, providing several lengthy options when the user asked a simple question/request. Of course, introducing repetitions in lists would also have to be penalized in Concision.

Satisfaction and Preference Ranking

- For Satisfaction, just make sure you are utilizing the table on page 196 of the Guidelines, and do NOT rate based on your personal preferences – there is some room for subjectivity and personal opinion here, but it is mostly based on the Guidelines
- Also remember that if no dimensions have been downgraded, the Satisfaction rating of that response must be *Highly Satisfying*. And the other way around, if any dimension has been slightly downgraded, the response cannot be *Highly Satisfying*
- For the Preference Ranking, please do not overuse the '*Much Better*' ranking. '*Much Better*' should only be reserved for cases where there are 2 or more degrees of individual Satisfaction rating differences (for example, if Response A is *Slightly Satisfying*, and Response B is *Highly Unsatisfying*, then Response A is *Much Better* than Response B). This means that in the certification you'll mostly be using the '*Better*' and '*Slightly Better*' rankings.